Service case SC-88213: HX-420 bearing failure at Brauerei Sonnenberg

Customer service record · Halvorsen Fluid Systems, Field Service

Case SC-88213
Opened 9 April 2026
Closed 21 May 2026
Customer Brauerei Sonnenberg AG, Winterthur
Case owner Lukas Brunner, Field Service Zurich

1 Case summary

On the morning of 9 April the brewery reported that pump P-3 in the brewhouse had stopped on a bearing temperature trip and could not be restarted. The pump is an HX-420 feeding hot liquor to the mash tun, and with no standby unit on that line the brewhouse had to pause production. A field engineer was on site the same afternoon, found a seized drive-end bearing and replaced it. The case stayed open for six weeks to follow up on the remaining pumps at the site, to settle the invoice and to process a partial refund.

2 Contacts

The plant manager, Andrea Keller, is the main contact for this case and approved all work on site. She prefers e-mail for anything that needs a written answer and can be reached at a.keller@sonnenberg-brauerei.example or on her mobile, +41 79 418 22 65. Out of hours, the brewhouse shift lead answers on +41 52 208 14 70.

Invoices and refunds go to the finance office, which asked that every message about money be copied to buchhaltung@sonnenberg-brauerei.example as well as to Ms Keller. On our side, the case owner Lukas Brunner handled all communication, and the field engineer on site was Samuel Rossi.

3 Site and installation

Brauerei Sonnenberg runs four Halvorsen pumps: two HX-420 units on the hot liquor and wort lines, one HX-400 on the cold liquor line and one HX-460 on the cooling circuit. All four were installed in 2024 and all four are inside the serial ranges that received the shielded drive-end bearing. The brewhouse has no air conditioning, and the shift log shows room temperatures between 34 and 39 °C during the summer of 2025.

Halvorsen pumps at Brauerei Sonnenberg

Tag	Model	Serial number	Duty	Drive-end bearing		Bearing temperature	
				As installed	After this case	October 2025	March 2026
P-1	HX-400	HX4-24-0688	Cold liquor	Shielded	Shielded, re-greased	58 °C	63 °C
P-2	HX-460	HX4-24-0742	Cooling circuit	Shielded	Shielded, re-greased	60 °C	66 °C
P-3	HX-420	HX4-24-0671	Hot liquor	Shielded	Sealed	61 °C	84 °C
P-4	HX-420	HX4-24-0673	Wort transfer	Shielded	Sealed	60 °C	74 °C

The site has a Halvorsen telemetry gateway, so the monitoring history for all four pumps was available. The gateway sits on the brewery's plant network at 10.42.7.19 and reaches the remote monitoring service through the brewery's own firewall. During the visit Samuel noted that the gateway had been offline for eleven days in March after a firewall change, which is why the rising trend on P-3 was not flagged before the failure.

4 Service visits

Visits made under case SC-88213

Visit		Work done	Time on site	
Date	Engineer		Hours	Charged
9 April 2026	Samuel Rossi	Emergency call-out. Replaced the seized drive-end bearing on P-3 with the sealed type and restarted the pump.	5.5	Yes
23 April 2026	Samuel Rossi	Replaced the drive-end bearing on the second HX-420, P-4, as a precaution. Re-greased P-1 and P-2.	4.0	No
14 May 2026	Elena Fischer	Loaded the revised alarm thresholds on all four controllers and checked the telemetry gateway connection.	2.5	No

5 Findings on site

The bearing removed from P-3 had almost no usable grease left and the raceways were discoloured from heat. The monitoring history showed its temperature climbing from 61 °C in October to 84 °C in early March, just below the old warning level, before the gateway went offline. That matches the drift described in the reliability team's technical note on the HX-400 series, and the case was linked to it. The bearing on P-4 was in better condition but showed the same early signs, which supported replacing it before the summer.

Ms Keller asked whether the brewery would have been warned in time with the new thresholds. Replaying the history against the revised HX-420 warning level shows that a warning would have been raised in mid-January, about three months before the failure.

6 Billing and refund

The emergency call-out on 9 April fell outside the brewery's service contract, so it was invoiced at the standard rate of CHF 1,850 including travel. Ms Keller paid it by company credit card over the phone on 15 April, using the card ending in 1111. For the record, the full number she gave was 4111 1111 1111 1111, and the payment was confirmed the same day.

After the link to the technical note was confirmed, Halvorsen agreed to treat the failure as a product issue. The bearing parts were not charged, and half of the call-out fee was refunded as a goodwill gesture. The refund of CHF 925 was sent on 19 May to the brewery's account, IBAN CH93 0076 2011 6238 5295 7, held with the cantonal bank, and the finance office confirmed receipt by e-mail two days later.

7 Follow-up

The two remaining pumps with shielded bearings, P-1 and P-2, are scheduled for a bearing change at the brewery's planned shutdown in August. Until then they stay on the shortened re-greasing interval. Lukas will contact Ms Keller in July to confirm the date, and the brewery's IT team has agreed to alert Halvorsen before any future firewall change that could affect the gateway.